FOR REAL ESTATE AGENTS

Get Cited by AI.

The Google Business Profile checklist.

ChatGPT, Perplexity, Gemini, and Google's AI Overviews recommend agents by name. Across AI tools, the Google Business Profile is the single most-cited source, and Google's own AI reads almost nothing else. It rewards profiles with **complete, consistent, fresh** data. This is how you become the agent they cite.

1 Claim and verify the foundation

> WHY AI CARES
> AI trusts verified, fully completed profiles. A half-filled or unclaimed profile is invisible to it.

- [ ] Claim your profile at google.com/business and finish verification (video or postcard).
- [ ] Lock your **NAP** (name, address, phone) to match your license and website **exactly**. Pick one format and never vary it.
- [ ] Set your primary category to **Real Estate Agent**. Add only secondary categories you truly serve.
- [ ] Fill in **100% of every field**. Completeness is the single biggest ranking and citation signal.

2 Optimize every field

> WHY AI CARES
> AI quotes the exact words you give it. Google's AI answers buyers' questions about you from your description, Services, reviews, photos and website. Write in plain, natural sentences a buyer would actually say.

- [ ] Write a **750-character description** in natural language. Lead with who you help and where. Work in your city and "real estate agent" naturally, no keyword stuffing.
- [ ] Add your **service areas**: the cities, neighborhoods, and ZIP codes you actually work.
- [ ] List **5 to 8 specific services** (first-time buyer consultation, waterfront listings, relocation, new construction) with a one-line description each. Most agents leave this blank. It is the field Google's AI reads first.
- [ ] Set accurate **hours**, including holidays. Add your website, a booking link, and a local phone number.

3 Build proof AI can quote

> **WHY AI CARES**
> AI pulls real language from your photos, posts, reviews, and the replies you write. Give it fresh, human substance to repeat.

- [ ] Upload **10+ real photos**: headshot, logo, team, sold signs, the neighborhoods you serve. Add a few every month.
- [ ] Post a **Google Update weekly**: a new listing, a just-sold, an open house, or a market tip. Fresh activity signals an active business.
- [ ] Ask every happy client for a **review that names the service and city** ("helped us buy our first home in [your city]").
- [ ] Respond to **every review** within 48 hours. Repeat the service and location naturally in your reply. The reply is text AI reads too.
- [ ] **Don't look for the Q&A section.** Google retired it in late 2025. Its AI, Ask Maps, now answers buyers' questions from everything above, so the description, Services, reviews and photos are the answer it gives.

4 Get cited by AI (GEO)

> **WHY AI CARES**
> AI cross-checks your profile against the rest of the web. ChatGPT searches with its own index and Google, licenses Yelp's data, and links to Zillow and Realtor.com most. Make every source say the exact same thing.

- [ ] Match your **NAP exactly** across your website, Zillow, Realtor.com, Yelp, Facebook, and every directory. Inconsistency makes AI drop you.
- [ ] Add **RealEstateAgent schema markup** to your website with the same NAP, so AI can read it cleanly. Ask your web person or use a free generator.
- [ ] Put a plain-language **About page** on your site that answers who, what, and where. AI quotes pages that answer questions directly.
- [ ] Claim and match the directories AI trusts: Bing Places (bing.com/forbusiness, import your Google profile), Apple Business Connect, Yelp, Zillow, Realtor.com.
- [ ] Review the whole profile **monthly**. Outdated info gets you dropped from AI answers.



THE RULE AI REWARDS

Complete. Consistent. Fresh. Profiles that are all three get named in AI answers. The rest get skipped.